

10 Foot GUI

The interface of most media center software uses what is called a 10 foot GUI, for easy navigation from a distance

Boxee to invade iPhones

Not satisfied with capturing TV screens across USA, Boxee is working on streaming TV content to iPods and iPhones

Movie...da! Media Center Applications are a fun way to browse and view media content on your computer. We show you how you can sit back, relax and enjoy!

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With the proliferation of HTPCs, media centre applications are becoming more essential than ever. The idea is to plug in a wireless keyboard cum mouse (or an air remote), sit back, relax and experience media in an easy,

The installation process is quite straight forward. Check the Install recommended plug-in automatically box to make sure most of the popular plug-ins are automatically added.

Interface and navigation

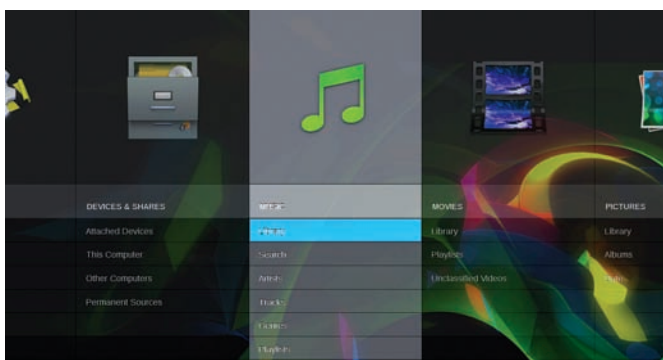
The interface is visually appealing and is designed to

Content Plugins

One of the best features of Moovida is its ability to pull in content from the web. This is done through the plugins tab, which is the last tab on the right. The Library button helps you browse through all the plugins currently installed in your Moovida installation. You basically have plugins that will pull in web videos from different sources such as TED, YouTube and CNN – plugins that will tap into internet radio services such as Shout-

Playing options

The software has support for most formats out there, so once all your media has been detected (which will take a considerable amount of time), you can get on to browsing / playing it in interesting ways. Moovida downloads cover art and other information of all related media such as music and movies. You also get plot synopsis for movies and TV episodes. As a test case, we dumped some mixed videos comprising movies and TV series episodes. The software accurately assigned each of the



Moovida's interface is HTPC friendly

visually appealing way. Most people don't know that there are options in this space other than the ubiquitous Windows Media Center. Moovida is one such easy to use software that will allow you to watch your movies in almost all formats, listen to your music, view your photos in nicely animated slide-shows, and much more.

Getting started

Pop in our Playware DVD or download the installer from <http://www.moovida.com/download/>.

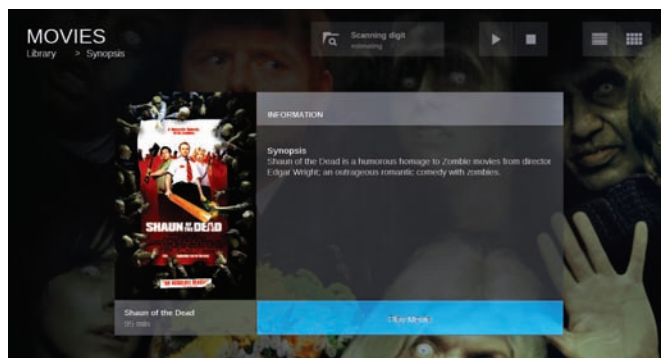
Minimum requirements

Windows XP / Vista / Win 7
Linux OS with X Window System
EWMH compliant window manager
Graphics card - Support for OpenGL 1.3 graphics with Pixel Shader 2.0 in hardware, 32 bits per pixel

be operated via the keyboard. Simply use your arrow keys, enter and backspace to navigate through the five neatly segregated menu columns. In terms of media, you have a column each for Music, Movies, Pictures, TV shows, and internet media. The other columns are for Settings, Devices and Shares and Plug-ins. It couldn't get simpler than this.

Scanning media

Most of us use other folders, and you can add you can add your movies by going to the 'Devices and Shares' column. Here you will find an item called 'This Computer'. Browse to the appropriate folder and click the plus sign to add. It will ask you the type of media in the folder. Be patient; Moovida takes long to scan.



Synopsis and DVD cover art for the movie Shaun of The Dead

Cast; audio streaming services such as GrooveShark that will play almost any song on earth for free and plugins that will pull image from services such as Flickr and Deviant art. All this content is showcased in an easy to browse and categorised manner. For instance, the YouTube plugin will let you not only search but also browse videos by category and ratings. You can view top rated videos for the day or of all time, or most viewed, or even the most recent. To add more plugins you have the 'Available Plugins' button in the main menu.

videos into proper categories. Clicking on the 'i' button gave us information about the exact episode selected. As for pictures, there are fun slide shows. **d**



Check out these Media Center applications and tell us what you think of them:

MediaPortal - A powerful and highly customisable media center with focus on TV viewing and DMR

Boxee - A full function and fun to use media center with social media features

Miro - Fully geared to pull in video content from lots of web sources